

API ENDPOINT & AJAX POLLING CONTRACT

1. API Endpoint Contract

All endpoints are namespaced under `/api/`. Every protected endpoint verifies, in order: valid session → correct role → resource ownership.

ID	Module	Endpoint	Method	Auth	Request / Payload	Response / Result
BE-01	Auth	/api/auth/login.php	POST	Public	email, pin	role, user, session/token
BE-02	Auth	/api/auth/logout.php	POST	Logged in	-	session invalidated
BE-03	Patient	/api/patients/register.php	POST	Public	patient + pet details	patient and pet IDs
BE-04	Patient	/api/patients/profile.php	GET / POST	Patient	profile changes	own profile and pet data
BE-05	Doctor	/api/doctors/register.php	POST multipart	Public	profile + documents	application ID, pending
BE-06	Doctor	/api/doctors/list.php	GET	Public/Patient	search, specialization, online	approved doctor list
BE-07	Availability	/api/doctors/availability.php	POST	Approved Doctor	is_online	updated status
BE-08	Wallet	/api/wallet/details.php	GET	Patient	-	balance and transactions
BE-09	Wallet	/api/wallet/recharge.php	POST	Patient/Admin/Test	amount, mode, reference	credit transaction and balance
BE-10	Admin	/api/admin/doctors/pending.php	GET	Admin	filters	pending applications
BE-11	Admin	/api/admin/doctors/update-status.php	POST	Admin	approve/reject, remark	updated approval state
BE-12	Admin	/api/admin/settings.php	GET / POST	Admin	rate, commission, minimum	validated platform settings
BE-13	Chat Request	/api/chat/request.php	POST	Patient Session	doctor_id, pet_id	stored request ID and pending status
BE-14	Chat Response	/api/chat/respond.php	POST	Approved Doctor Session	request_id, action	active session or rejected status
BE-15	Chat Messages	/api/chat/messages.php	GET / POST	Session Participant	session_id, message or last_message_id	saved message or ordered new-message list
BE-16	Chat Session	/api/chat/session.php	GET / POST	Session Participant	session_id, action	session status, server timing and billing data
BE-17	History	/api/chat/history.php	GET	Patient/Doctor	pagination/filter	authorized session/message history
BE-18	Earnings	/api/doctors/earnings.php	GET	Doctor	date filters	today/total earning and ledger
BE-19	Support	/api/support/enquiries.php	GET / POST	Public/Admin	enquiry or filters	created/listed enquiry

Non-negotiable rules

- Billing timing is always server-side — never trust a client-sent timestamp or amount (BE-16).
- Wallet debit/credit operations (BE-09, and internal billing debits) run inside a database transaction with an idempotency check on reference_id.
- Doctor documents uploaded via BE-05 are never served by a public URL — only through an authenticated, role-gated script.
- chat/messages.php and chat/session.php verify the caller is one of the two session participants before returning anything.

2. AJAX Polling Contract

2.1 Chat Messages — GET /api/chat/messages.php

Field	Value	Notes
Poll interval	2–3 seconds	Stops once session status (from 2.2) is "ended".
Cursor	last_message_id	Client sends the highest message ID it already has; server returns only id > last_message_id, ascending.
Send message	POST, same endpoint	session_id + message_text. Validated: non-empty, max length, sender must be a participant. Returns saved row immediately.
Reconnect behaviour	cursor persists	Refresh does not reset last_message_id to 0 — re-syncs from where it left off.

2.2 Session & Billing Status — GET /api/chat/session.php

Field	Value	Notes
Poll interval	5 seconds	Slower than messages — drives the live cost/timer display.
Response fields	status, elapsed_seconds, current_cost, wallet_balance, low_balance_warning	elapsed_seconds and current_cost are always computed server-side from started_at and admin_settings.rate_per_minute.
Ending a session	POST, action=end	Must be idempotent — checks billing_records.billing_status first; returns existing result if already finalized.
Auto-end	server-triggered	Session force-ended server-side once balance would go negative; next poll simply returns status: "ended".

2.3 Doctor Availability Heartbeat — POST /api/doctors/availability.php

Field	Value	Notes
Direction	client → server (inverse poll)	Doctor's browser periodically confirms it is still open, rather than fetching data.
Interval	30 seconds	While the doctor's dashboard is open and toggled online.
Staleness window	~90 seconds (3 missed heartbeats)	Doctor directory query (BE-06) filters out doctors whose last_seen_at has gone stale, even if is_online is still true.